

right-clicking on the workspace. You can also create your new Script-Fu to create your scripts by clicking on the Xtns > Script-Fu > Script-Fu Console. You can search commands and keywords that can be referred to, by pressing the Browse button.

GIMP Optimisations

Image editing software need to handle large images and they can get really heavy. With many steps involved, the history can really over-utilise system resources. Some amount of tweaking is possible from Preferences in the File menu. Click on the Environment item on the left. You can set memory limits on the history and thumbnails generated.

Adding Custom Tabs To The Toolbar

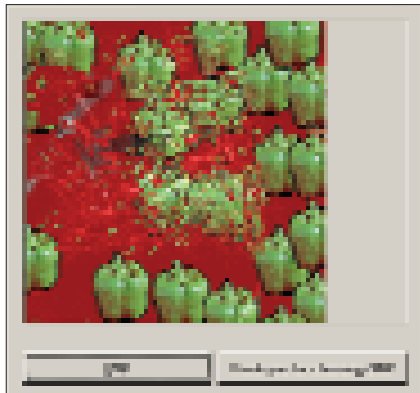
The toolbars of GIMPshop are modular, which means you can add or detach features from it. Tabs can be added to the toolbar by clicking on the arrow pointing to the left, then click on Add Tab. Choose from the tabs you want to add. Similarly, Tabs can be detached into separate toolbars by clicking on Detach.

Panning The Image

Panning of the image is required when you zoom into one or you're working with an image of really high resolutions. Using the space bar will move the image around itself. An easy way to keep track of the image while moving through it is to use the move icon on the right button of the window. Hold the left mouse click down and move the mouse arrow to pan through the image.

Toys!

This is no Easter bug, but GIMPshop has a few little fun features called Toys. First, create a new image or open an existing one with decent amount of detail. Now click on Filter > Toys. There is one called GEE-Slime, which uses a water-like effect rendered



Play around with GIMP's toys

in real-time on the image you have open. The other toy—GEE-Zoom gives a 3D illusion. Use the mouse to move in and out of the image.

PRODUCTIVITY

We all want to work smart, right? Here are a bunch of things we've learnt from our own experiences, and some that have only just occurred to us.

Control The Future

If you want to remind yourself of an event in the future, send yourself an e-mail! Time Machiner (www.timemachiner.com) is an online service that lets you send yourself an e-mail at a future date. Just visit the site, choose a date,



Break the time barrier with TimeMachiner

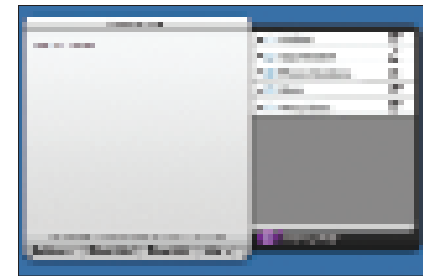
and type the e-mail. The shock of receiving an e-mail from your past self will likely be enough to make the event or task register in your mind.

SMS Reminders

If you're a Google Calendar user, you can get it to send you event reminders by SMS—just go to Settings > Mobile setup to set up your phone number. Nearly all Indian mobile providers are supported, and it's free!

Nota Bene

The first step to increasing your productivity is to take notes whenever a noteworthy idea strikes you. You could turn to good old Notepad (we've been there), or install one of the billion "sticky notes" applications available on the Web. The drawback with these approaches, however, is the fact that notes you take at home won't come to the office with you, and vice versa. The most hassle-free solution, we've found, is Yahoo! Notepad. Install Yahoo! Widgets and activate only the Yahoo! Notepad Widget (not that there's anything wrong with activating others) on

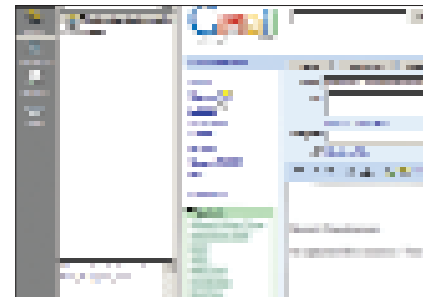


The most hassle-free way to take notes

all the PCs you'll be using. When an idea strikes you, jot it down in the widget, and forget about it. The widget uploads this note to your online Yahoo! Notepad, and you can now access it from anywhere! We assume, of course, that you have Internet access at the aforementioned locations, otherwise this is admittedly pointless.

Nota Bene, Part 2

You can create e-mail templates in Outlook, but what if you don't want to lose that functionality if you're using Web-based e-mail? What if you had a standard reply for all e-mails on a particular subject ("I did not have relations with that woman!") but didn't want to type it out all the time? For Opera users, there's a way out—Copy to Note. Just type the e-mail once, select all the text, right-click and choose Copy to Note. You can access these notes in the



If you have standard text you use often, store it as a note

sidebar (take your mouse cursor to the left of the screen and click). Unfortunately, you can't click and drag the text into Gmail's Compose Mail text area, but it's handy to have this text for ready copy-pasting nonetheless.

Organising Your Inbox Right

Whether it's Web mail or Outlook, it pays to be able to look at your inbox and immediately know what tasks you must prioritise. Here, we must follow the teachings of GTD (Getting Things Done), though you can add your own twist to it. Most importantly, you should be checking your e-mail at designated times of the day, or when someone specifically tells you it's urgent that you do so.

Mentally divide your e-mail into five categories—mail that can be addressed in the next five minutes, mail that needs to be addressed soon and is high-priority, mail that needs to be addressed soon but is secondary priority, mail that needs to be eventually addressed, but can wait a few days, and finally, mail that you don't really need to do anything about. If you receive an e-mail that can be addressed in the next five minutes, address it—get it off your back as soon as you can. For the rest, create folders—Priority 1, Priority 2, If I get time, Information, Done, and so on. Sort your mail every time you check it, and you'll find yourself looking at a clean, un-cluttered inbox.

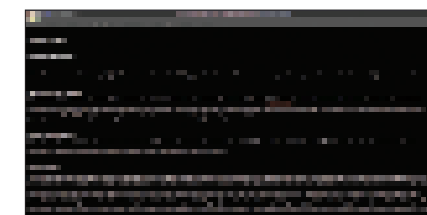
Folders in your inbox appear in alphabetical order, but you should really sort them in order of importance. To do this, precede the folder's name with a number—"0Priority 1", for example, will ensure that this folder's always on top, ready for your attention.

Just don't forget to actually do the work, though.

Word? Notepad?

Office 2007's Ribbon offers you a more uncluttered interface as it is, but if you're running at low resolutions or if the Ribbon still bothers you, you can minimise it—just double-click on one of the tabs. This gives Word a Notepad-like look, where you can concentrate all your energies on typing and not be distracted by any graphical elements.

Another handy tip, as you'll witness in the screenshot: if you're working for extended periods on a CRT monitor,



Minimise the ribbon for a clutter-free Word

change the page colour to black (Page Layout Tab > Page Colour) to ease the strain on your eyes.

Archive, Archive, Archive

Gmail has spoiled us all, really—thanks to the "never delete" philosophy, we're left with inboxes that often say "1–50 of 1687" (or some such ridiculous figure) at the bottom. Most of us don't register that the "never delete" is really "never delete, archive!". Use labels liberally (preferably organised the way we've mentioned above), and once you've applied a label to an e-mail, archive it. It'll still be visible when you click on the label, so it's really like moving e-mail to a folder in Outlook.

Windows Run Commands

Command	Description
Applications	
calc	Starts Calculator
excel	Starts Microsoft Excel
explorer	Starts Windows Explorer
firefox	Starts Firefox if installed
iexplore	Internet Explorer
mobsync	Starts Microsoft Synchronization Tool
msimn	Outlook Express
mspaint	Starts Microsoft Paint
notepad	Starts Notepad
outlook	Starts Microsoft Outlook
powerpnt	Starts Microsoft PowerPoint
wab	Starts Windows Address Book
winchat	Starts Microsoft Chat
winword	Starts Microsoft Word
wordpad	Starts Wordpad
Control Panel	
appwiz.cpl	Starts Add or Remove Programs
control	Starts the Control Panel
control desktop	Opens Display Properties
control folders	Opens Folder Options
control fonts	Opens Fonts
control mouse	Opens Mouse settings
control netconnections	Opens Network Connections
control schedtasks	Opens Scheduled Tasks
control userpasswords	Opens Users Accounts
firewall.cpl	Starts Windows Firewall
mmsys.cpl	Starts Sound and Audio Device Properties
netsetup.cpl	Starts Network Setup Wizard
powercfg.cpl	Starts Power Options Properties
sysdm.cpl	Opens System Properties
wuaucl.cpl	Starts Windows Updates
Administration	
ciadv.msc	Opens Indexing Service
compmgmt.msc	Opens Computer Management
devmgmt.msc	Opens Device Manager
diskmgmt.msc	Opens Disk Management
eventvwr.msc	Opens Event Viewer
fsmgmt.msc	Opens Shared Folders Management
gpedit.msc	Starts Group Policy Editor
ntmsmgr.msc	Opens Removable Storage Management
perfmon.msc	Opens Performance Monitor
secpol.msc	Opens Security Policies
services.msc	Opens Services Management
Utilities	
chkdsk	Runs Check Disk (eg. chkdsk c:)
clipbrd	Opens Clipboard Viewer
cmd	Starts a Command Prompt window
diskpart	Runs Microsoft Disk Partitioning tool
drwtsn32	Runs Dr. Watson Debugger
dxdiag	Runs DirectX Diagnostic Tool
eudcedit	Starts Private Character Editor
fsquirt	Runs Bluetooth Transfer Wizard
logoff	Logs off user from Windows
msconfig	Starts System Configuration Utility
mstsc	Starts Remote Desktop Connection
osk	Starts On Screen Keyboard
packager	Opens packager
regedit	Starts Registry Editor
shutdown	Runs Windows shutdown command
taskmgr	Runs Task Manager
tourstart	Starts Windows Tour